

PREPARING TISANES

Part of the appeal of a tisane lies in its preparation. Making your own tisanes at home can be a rewarding experience, especially as you become familiar with the various ingredients, and how to dry and store them.

FINDING INGREDIENTS

You will easily be able to find all the herbs, spices, or fruits that you would like to use in your tisanes in health-food stores or online, but you can also grow many herbs, such as rosemary, mint, sage, and thyme, in your own garden. Other ingredients, such as ginger, cloves, and cinnamon, are everyday pantry items.

Exercise caution if you decide to forage for ingredients—avoid gathering anything from roadsides, where plants are exposed to exhaust fumes and your own safety may be at risk, or from places where chemical fertilizers and pesticides have been used. If gathering roots, ensure that you do not damage other plants nearby. Also, never use flowers from a florist for tisanes as they are usually heavily sprayed with insecticides.

Prepared tisanes are widely available, too. Tea stores usually have a selection of tisanes with various flavors and aromas to cater to specific moods, and most supermarkets stock a range of tisanes, including immune-boosting blends to help fight colds.



ANTI-INFLAMMATORY

The combination of ginger, turmeric, and lemon is an anti-inflammatory and can help to relieve joint pain.



SAGE

A tisane made from sage can aid relaxation and is thought to ease anxiety and depression.

HOMEGROWN

Chamomile and lemon balm is a popular combination that calms the body and lifts the spirits. They are both easy to grow.

